

Observability Platform Comparison

DECISION VIEW

Company context: ELK for APM and logs; Prometheus for infrastructure and business monitoring

DIMENSION	CURRENT ELK + PROMETHEUS	FULL DYNATRACE ADOPTION
Log Search & Ad Hoc Analysis	Strong; mature full-text search and flexible troubleshooting workflows	Strong; query workflows and ingestion costs require validation
APM & Distributed Tracing	Good; broad service coverage, but current trace volume creates substantial ES pressure	Stronger automatic instrumentation, discovery, and contextual analysis
Service Topology	Depends on agent coverage and consistent service metadata	More mature automatic topology and dependency discovery
Root Cause Analysis	Manual correlation across Kibana, Prometheus, and alerts	Stronger automated correlation, anomaly detection, and causal analysis
Kubernetes Monitoring	Prometheus is cloud-native and already established in the environment	Highly automated, with infrastructure-to-application context
Business Metrics	Mature PromQL queries, exporters, dashboards, and alerting rules	Requires integration or migration of existing metrics and rules
Advanced Log Analytics	Major Elastic strength; familiar search and investigation experience	Capable, but DQL adoption and retention economics must be assessed
Platform Operations	High: Kafka, Logstash, Elasticsearch, lifecycle, shard, and capacity management	Lower infrastructure burden; more responsibility moves to the vendor
Cost Model	Infrastructure, storage, and engineering labor; trace volume is the main cost driver	Commercial licensing and data consumption; requires a measured PoC
Data Ownership & Control	High, with self-managed storage and retention policies	Lower; depends on the selected SaaS or managed deployment model
Vendor Lock-in	Medium	High
Migration Risk	None for the current operating model	Very high for a full replacement

Assessment focus: capability fit, operating burden, data economics, and migration risk.